

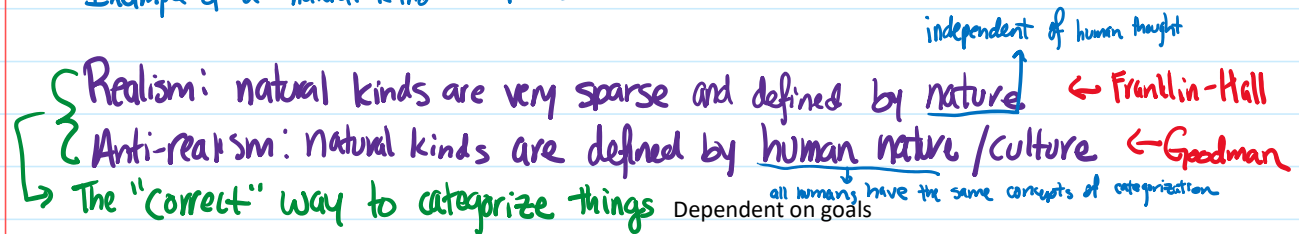
Natural Kinds

Friday, February 28, 2020

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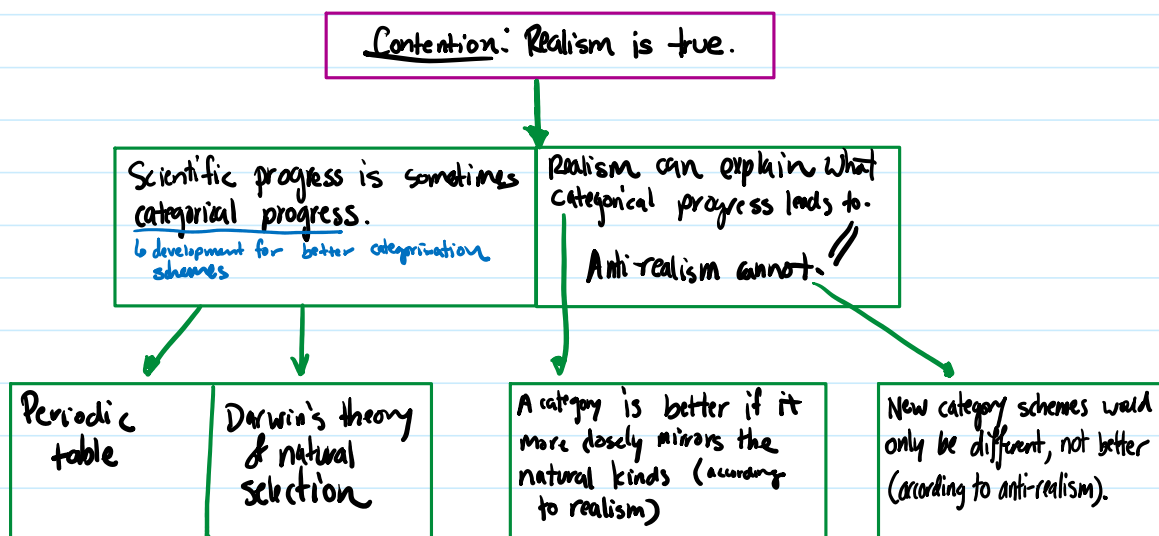
Natural Kinds

- Argument: there exists a division between groups defined by nature. Some categorizations are better than others.
 - ex. gold, pyrite should be in different groups
- Counterargument (Goodman): All groups are defined by language and matter of taste. All distinctions are equally valid.
- Example of a "natural kind": species



Some categories do not seem to have a "natural" definition - e.g. cookies vs cakes

An Argument for Realism



An Argument for Anti-Realism

Category influence hypothesis: Scientific classifications are influenced by the nature of the scientists themselves

once we decide categories,
objects can objectively be
categorized in this way

Contention: Realism about natural kinds is
false.



If realism is true, we
would never know what the
natural kinds actually are.

It doesn't make sense to talk
about which kinds are
natural if we'll never know.

↪ no independent, valid
belief forming method.

★ Epistemic Relativism and natural kind anti-realism challenges the
objectivity proposed by scientism.